



Brand Story & Guidelines

Who we are. What we do. How we sound. How we look.

Customer-first content, refined for trust, AI visibility, and ROI.

ReadTomato.com · LetsTalk@ReadTomato.com · 530-828-6764 · © 2025

0 1 - T H E S T O R Y

Why ReadTomato Exists

Most businesses don't have a content problem. They have a clarity problem. A consistency problem. A "my website hasn't kept up with who I actually am" problem.

ReadTomato was built to fix that. Not with more content. Not with faster output. With better content — content shaped around what a client actually knows, what their market actually needs to hear, and what genuinely moves a prospect from curious to convinced.

We've been doing this work since 2006. In that time, we've helped more than 2,500 companies find their voice, rebuild their digital presence, and turn real expertise into content that earns attention, builds trust, and creates commercial momentum. The platforms have changed. The way audiences discover, evaluate, and trust businesses has shifted more in the last three years than in the previous fifteen. But the core work — understanding what a client knows, bridging that gap to what their market needs to hear, and delivering it with genuine craft — has never mattered more.

"Every piece of content we produce will be 100% homemade. It will never come from a can."

That principle runs through everything we do. It is why we don't sell templates. It is why we don't use generic prompts and pass off AI output as strategy. It is why we start every engagement by understanding the client's business reality — their market, their audience, their commercial pressures — before we write a single word.

We are a customer-first company. That phrase gets used a lot, so let us be specific about what it means to us. It means the work is always in service of the client's outcomes, not our own convenience. It means "good enough" is never good enough when someone has trusted us with their brand and their business. It means the finished work should always look like it took serious effort — because it did.

That is the ReadTomato story. And it is the context for everything in this guide.

The Philosophy Behind the Work

What we believe shapes every editorial and visual decision this company makes. It shapes what we build for clients. It shapes what this brand looks and sounds like at every touchpoint.

We Listen Before We Write

Every client brings a business reality to the table. A market they understand better than any outside agency ever will. Customers they know how to talk to. Expertise earned over years of doing real work. Our job begins there — not with a keyword list, not with a content calendar, but with a genuine effort to understand what the client knows and what their audience still needs to hear.

We do not arrive with a pre-formed voice and apply it like a coat of paint. We listen first. We refine what's already there. We make the client's real expertise legible, compelling, and commercially useful. That is the work.

We Refine. We Do Not Decorate.

There is a difference between content that looks polished and content that performs. We are not interested in decoration. We are not interested in activity that generates reports but not results. We are interested in the kind of work that improves trust, increases search and AI visibility, strengthens positioning, and helps generate qualified opportunities.

That means every decision should serve a purpose. Structure should help a message land more clearly. Design should help a reader feel confident in what they are reading. Language should eliminate confusion. Every word, every layout choice, every visual accent should earn its place.

We Build for Outcomes

Our clients do not come to us for content for its own sake. They come because something needs to change. Their website is losing people at the first scroll. Their expertise is generating conversations but not the kind of inbound credibility that reduces dependence on paid leads. Their brand sounds like everyone else in a market where trust is fragile and differentiation is everything.

That commercial reality is the context for every product we offer. ReadTomato should never feel generic, noisy, inflated, or trend-chasing. It should feel clear, disciplined, commercially

aware, and deeply useful — because our clients are serious, and they deserve a partner who treats their investment with the same seriousness they brought to building their business.

"When it comes to the work we produce, "good enough" is never good enough."

Craft Is a Client Promise

The finished work should always look like it took serious effort. It should feel meticulously crafted — shaped by painstaking attention to the client's market, audience, and commercial goals. This is not for vanity. It is for confidence.

Clients stay. They expand. They refer. When they can see that the work was handled with rare care and real expertise. That is the standard we hold ourselves to, and it is the standard that runs through every piece of work that carries the ReadTomato name.

ReadTomato does not create noise. It creates client value. It does not decorate ideas. It sharpens them for trust, visibility, and results. It does not refresh content for appearance alone. It rebuilds content for clarity, authority, and ROI.

03 - THE PRODUCTS

What ReadTomato Delivers

ReadTomato is organized around a simple truth: most businesses have more valuable expertise than the world currently recognizes. The gap between what they know and what their market understands is a missed commercial opportunity. Our products exist to close that gap.

There are two ways that gap shows up. The first is ongoing — a professional with real knowledge and no consistent way to express it publicly. The second is foundational — a

website that has drifted away from where the business actually is, what it actually offers, and why it is actually worth trusting. We built a product for each.

Hot Take Engine™

Turn One Conversation Into a Month of AI-Visible Content

Hot Take Engine is a guided content system that turns your team's real-world expertise into persona-driven articles and social content designed to surface in search and AI discovery. The way people find businesses has changed. Traditional blogs and social posts disappear into the feed or get buried in search. Hot Take Engine was built for a different environment — one where your expertise needs to be clear, structured, and present where Google and AI systems look for answers.

The problem most professionals face is not a lack of ideas. It is a lack of process. Their best market insight stays trapped inside calls, meetings, and client conversations — never converted into the kind of structured, publishable content that builds authority over time. Hot Take Engine fixes that without making content creation a burden.

How It Works

Once a month, our team leads a structured 60-minute guided conversation with you or your team. We pull out insights, stories, local expertise, explanations, and perspective. Our editorial team then shapes that conversation into clean, audience-aligned content — structured for how search engines and AI systems now read, interpret, and surface information.

- 1 guided 60-minute recorded call per month
- 8 persona-driven blog articles, shaped for your audience
- 12+ polished social media snippets, ready to publish
- SEO-optimized headlines, descriptions, and metadata
- Structured copy designed for AI extraction and search discovery
- Sourced images for streamlined publishing

We do not rely on guesswork for topic selection. Before every call, our team identifies the questions, themes, and angles most likely to matter to your audience and your market — buyer and seller psychology, market interpretation, common myths, local expertise, and the micro-insights that build authority and trust over time.

The result is a repeatable monthly visibility rhythm that positions the business as a credible, active, informed authority — without the content bottleneck. One hour of your time generates a full month of polished, strategic content output.

Pricing

Monthly Engine: \$1,550/month — 1 guided call, 8 blog articles, 12+ social snippets

Bi-Monthly Engine: \$2,250/month — 2 guided calls, 16 blog articles, 24+ social snippets

Optional add-ons: Video edits, email newsletters, custom graphics

WebReno™ — Content Cleaning System

Turn Your Existing Website Into a Clear, Trustworthy, High-Performing Asset

WebReno is the systematic process of turning your existing website content into a clear, trustworthy, search-readable asset that both humans and AI systems can understand, index, and reward. Most sites don't have a content problem — they have a clarity, consistency, and technical hygiene problem. WebReno fixes that.

It removes friction. Resolves contradictions. Tightens positioning. Strengthens trust signals. Makes every page easier to rank, easier to convert, and easier for AI tools to summarize accurately. The outcome is not a website that looks updated. It is a website that works — a coherent sales and authority system that reflects the business as it actually exists today.

What Changes After a WebReno

- Messaging becomes consistent across every page of the site
- Pages read like they were designed with purpose, not accumulated over time
- Calls-to-action become clearer and better positioned for conversion
- Google can more accurately interpret intent, structure, and topical authority
- AI assistants are less likely to misrepresent the business — because the content is explicit, structured, and unambiguous
- Outdated claims, conflicting statements, thin pages, and SEO leftovers are removed

Clients commonly see a meaningful boost in both Google and AI-sourced visibility within the first week as cleaned pages are reprocessed. Conversion lift on cleaned money pages typically runs 10% to 30%. Organic impressions and clicks commonly improve 15% to 40% within 60 to 120 days — depending on crawl cycles and baseline authority.

The Cleaning Process

Step 1 — Intake: Align on priority outcomes, target audiences, money pages, and trust pages. Confirm any compliance constraints.

Step 2 — Inventory: Crawl and classify every page: keep and clean, consolidate, rewrite/rebuild, or prune.

Step 3 — Diagnosis: Evaluate each page against the failure modes that quietly kill performance — intent mismatch, thinness, duplication, weak trust signals, poor structure, and bad UX patterns.

Step 4 – Cleaning: Tighten the top of each page. Rebuild structure for search intent and AI extraction. Replace vague marketing language with specific, credible claims. Normalize brand voice.

Step 5 – Internal Linking: Reinforce topical clusters, fix orphaned pages, and strengthen hub pages.

Step 6 – Technical Hygiene: Title and meta alignment, canonical tags, schema recommendations, image alt text, and URL normalization where needed.

Step 7 – Handoff: Published cleaned pages, QA pass, tracking confirmation, and a Before/After summary.

Step 8 – Measurement: 30/60/90-day roadmap for what to watch, what to expand, and how Hot Take Engine publishing compounds the foundation.

Pricing

Standard Content Page: \$370 – blog posts, service descriptions, informational pages

Authority / Primary Page: \$430 – homepage, key service pages, conversion pages

Website Audit (required): \$650 for 1–25 pages · \$900 for 26–40 pages · \$1,250 for 41+ pages

Starter GEO Cleanup Pack: \$2,890 – top 10 pages cleaned (\$610 in savings)

GEO Content Maintenance: \$780/month – ongoing page updates, content refreshes, and structural improvements

RT SEO Monthly Packages

Continuous Search Visibility, Built and Managed for Your Market

Our SEO packages are designed for businesses that need ongoing technical optimization, keyword management, local authority building, and performance monitoring – paired with the content that makes optimization actually work.

RT SEO Starter – \$840/month: 6 keywords, comprehensive site audit, keyword analysis, source code optimization, copywriting recommendations, performance monitoring, and Google Business Profile management.

RT SEO Pro – \$1,450/month: 12 keywords, everything in Starter plus 2 local links per month and up to 5 pages of custom content supporting SEO goals.

RT SEO Premium – \$2,800/month: 24 keywords, everything in Pro plus 4 local links per month and up to 10 pages of custom content.

How the Products Work Together

Hot Take Engine and WebReno address different problems but they are expressions of the same core promise: ReadTomato takes what the client already knows and what the market still does not fully understand, then refines it into content built to perform.

WebReno establishes the foundation — a clean, credible, structurally sound site that search and AI can actually use. Hot Take Engine builds on that foundation with a consistent, compounding stream of authority content. SEO packages provide the ongoing technical layer that connects both to the way people actually search. Together, they form a complete content presence — one that strengthens over time rather than decaying.

Cleaning is foundational. It sets the stage for compounding gains when paired with ongoing publishing through Hot Take Engine and authority-building through SEO. Clients who use both don't just have better content. They have a coherent, compounding content presence that strengthens their market position month over month.

0 4 - W H O W E S E R V E

The Clients ReadTomato Is Built For

ReadTomato's products were built to address the specific pressures facing professionals in markets where trust is fragile, messaging is commoditized, and visibility is harder to win than it used to be.

Our primary clients are mortgage brokers, independent lenders, brokerage leaders, real estate agents, and independent professionals in regulated, relationship-driven markets. These are people who have built real expertise over real time — and whose digital presence consistently undersells what they actually deliver.

The Challenges Our Clients Are Living With

The professionals we serve face a specific and compounding set of pressures that generic marketing companies are not equipped to address:

- Their website was last updated years ago and no longer reflects their actual positioning or service reality
- Their best expertise lives in conversations and client calls — never converted into visible, searchable content

- AI-shaped discovery is changing who gets found and who gets passed over — and most professionals don't know where they stand
- Generic AI-written content is flooding every channel, making authentic, structured expertise more valuable — and harder to produce consistently
- Compliance requirements make self-editing risky — but leaving outdated language in place is riskier
- They are paying for SEO and content marketing but cannot point to real commercial outcomes from the investment

What They Are Not Looking For

Our clients are not looking for more content for the sake of activity. They are not impressed by volume metrics or content calendars that generate noise but no qualified attention. They have been burned before by marketing vendors who delivered the appearance of productivity without a measurable return.

They are looking for a partner who understands their market, respects the complexity of what they do, and produces work that demonstrates — to their clients, to their referral partners, and to the AI systems that increasingly mediate discovery — that this professional knows what they are doing and is worth trusting.

The goal is no longer just to publish more. The goal is to create content that can be found, summarized, cited, and trusted. That shift changes everything about how we approach the work.

0 5 - H O W W E S O U N D

The ReadTomato Voice

Voice is the most direct expression of what a company actually believes. The way ReadTomato writes should be immediately recognizable — in our own marketing, in the work we produce for clients, and in every touchpoint a prospect or partner encounters.

Our voice has four qualities that operate together. Remove any one of them and the writing stops sounding like ReadTomato.

Precise

Every word earns its place. We do not use five words when two will do. We do not use impressive-sounding language when plain language is clearer. We say what we mean, specifically, and we trust the reader to be intelligent enough to receive it without being entertained to death first. This applies to client work as much as to our own communications.

Confident

We do not apologize for having a point of view. We make statements. We take positions. We deliver direct, assured communication that signals to a reader: this is a professional who knows what they are talking about, and my time with this content is being well spent. Confidence in writing is not arrogance. It is the earned clarity of someone who has done the work.

Commercially Aware

We are always writing in service of an outcome. Not just the outcome of the piece — the clarity it provides, the trust it builds — but the commercial outcome beyond it. Does this content help a prospect understand why this professional is worth their time? Does it address the specific concern a buyer has at this stage of their journey? Commercial awareness does not mean transactional writing. It means never losing sight of why the content exists.

Human

Content that sounds like it was written by no one in particular earns the trust of no one in particular. The ReadTomato voice is human — specific, textured, occasionally wry, always direct. It sounds like a knowledgeable person talking to another person. This is especially important given the current content environment. The professionals who distinguish themselves will be the ones whose content is obviously the product of real thinking, real experience, and real care.

Words We Use. Words We Don't.

Use These

- **not "optimize" — we elevate, not automate** Refine
- **not "transparency" — clarity produces a measurable result** Clarity
- **not "thought leadership" — too overused to carry weight** Expertise
- **not "quality" — craft implies intention and skill** Craft
- **not "create" — building implies structure and permanence** Build
- **not "content strategy" — performance is the point** Content that performs

- **our positioning line for the AI-visibility era** Be Everyone's AI Answer.

Avoid These

- "Cutting-edge," "state-of-the-art," "world-class" — empty superlatives that signal nothing
- "Seamless," "robust," "scalable" — SaaS vocabulary that has lost all meaning
- "Leverage," "synergy," "ecosystem" — agency theater nobody believes
- Vague CTAs like "Learn More" or "Get Started" without specific context
- Content that could have been written about any company in any industry

Our Taglines

ReadTomato's primary tagline connects everything we do:

Creating Content Your Customers Will Love To Click.

Be Everyone's AI Answer.

- "We're Brand Story Builders and Call-To-Action Message Makers." — brand introduction contexts
- "We're The Creators Of Your Customer-Clicking Conversations." — sales and pitch contexts
- "Turning client messages into customer-clicking conversations." — LinkedIn and professional contexts

0 6 — H O W W E L O O K

Visual Identity Standards

The way ReadTomato looks should be a direct extension of the way ReadTomato thinks. Every visual decision — color, typography, spacing, logo treatment — should communicate the same qualities as our best writing: precise, confident, commercially aware, and human.

This is not a style guide in the decorative sense. It is a set of standards rooted in the belief that visual consistency is a form of client respect. When our materials look like they were made with the same care we put into our content, clients feel it. When they don't, that gap is noticed — consciously or not. Nothing in this chapter exists for aesthetic reasons alone.

The Logo

The ReadTomato logo has four approved versions. The tomato icon — red body, green leaf, flat graphic style — is the visual anchor of the entire identity. The wordmark pairs "read" in a neutral weight with "tomato" in brand red, followed by the trademark symbol.

Logo Icon Profile photos, favicons, app icons, embroidery. Minimum: 0.25 × 0.25 inches.

Logo Wordmark All standard marketing materials, presentations, documents, signatures. Minimum: 1.5 inches wide.

Wordmark + Tagline Letterheads, formal proposals, website headers, major advertising placements.

Wordmark + URL Social posts, digital ads, any context where driving traffic to ReadTomato.com is the goal.

The logo must always be surrounded by clear space equal to the x-height of the tomato icon on all sides. No text, imagery, or competing visual elements enter this zone. This rule applies to all four variants in all contexts.

Never Do

- Change, alter, or approximate any brand color in the logo
- Resize logo elements independently — it scales as one unit, always
- Skew, stretch, rotate, or distort the logo in any direction
- Remove any element from any lockup variant
- Place the logo on textured, photographic, or visually busy backgrounds without a clean solid-color buffer
- Add drop shadows, glows, gradients, borders, or effects not in the approved system

The Color System

ReadTomato's palette was built around warmth, authority, and clarity. Every color earns its place. Colors are communication decisions, not decorative choices.

Principal Colors

Tomato Green #329646 The leaf accent. Growth. Present in the logo icon and used for positive indicators, badge states, and select brand accents. Pantone 7739 C.

Deep Brand Red #6B1111 The brand's depth. Used for headers, pull quotes, and deep emphasis that needs weight without screaming. Pantone 188 C.

Deep Shadow Red #391616 The darkest brand tone. Background applications, footer depths, and design elements that need serious grounding. Pantone 4975 C.

Support Colors

Bright Tomato Red #EC2227 The brand's heartbeat. Primary CTAs, key highlights, the logo tomato. Reserved for moments that matter — never diluted by overuse. Pantone 1788 C.

Dark Tomato Red #BF2629 CTA hover and pressed states. Always paired with Bright Tomato Red. Pantone 1805 C.

Leaf Green #74B743 Success states, badges, positive indicators. Pantone 368 C.

Burnt Rust #923C1F Warm accent. Used for tagline emphasis and warm-toned callouts. Pantone 174 C.

Deep Navy #0B1F2C Navigation, hero bands, footer. The stable, serious anchor of every layout. Pantone 5395 C.

Warm Cream #EBE7D4 Testimonial bands, callout panels, light section backgrounds. Creates calm. Pantone 7499 C.

The tomato red (#EC2227) is the brand's most powerful visual signal. It should be reserved for CTAs, highlights, and the logo mark. Its urgency comes from restraint. Use it for everything and it signals nothing.

Body text lives in dark gray (#2E2E2E). Never in tomato red at small sizes — it fails WCAG contrast requirements. Navy (#0B1F2C) carries headings and authority elements. Cream (#EBE7D4) creates breathing room without the coldness of white.

Typography

ReadTomato's entire type system is built on two faces from the same family: Roboto Condensed and Roboto. No other typefaces are used. Ever.

Roboto Condensed carries the brand's authority. Headlines, subheads, navigation, labels, display text, eyebrows — all Roboto Condensed. Its compressed proportions convey confidence and efficiency. Every headline makes a claim and stands behind it.

Roboto brings the warmth. Body copy, supporting text, captions, form fields, UI text — all Roboto. Its open letterforms and generous line spacing make reading feel effortless even when the content is substantive.

Display / Hero Headlines: Roboto Condensed, weight 300. Large. Airy. Confident. Line height 1.1–1.15. White on dark backgrounds, navy or deep red on light.

Section Headers (H1): Roboto Condensed, weight 700. Deep Red. Establishes chapter authority.

Subheads (H2, H3): Roboto Condensed, weight 700. Navy or Deep Red. Sized proportionally.

Body Copy: Roboto, weight 400. Dark gray (#2E2E2E). Minimum 16px. Line height 1.6.

Lead / Intro Paragraphs: Roboto, weight 300. Slightly larger than body. Introduces key sections.

Navigation, Labels, Eyebrows: Roboto Condensed, weight 700, uppercase, letter-spacing 0.08em. Tomato red for section labels.

- Always use Roboto Condensed for headlines — never Roboto Regular at display sizes
- Always use Roboto for body text — never Roboto Condensed for long-form reading
- Minimum body text size: 16px — no exceptions
- All-caps only for short labels, navigation items, and footer metadata
- No third typeface. Ever. The system is Roboto and Roboto Condensed.

Visual Tone

The visual philosophy of ReadTomato is built on calm and intention. Our clients operate in markets where everything is competing for attention — feeds, notifications, ads, noise. Our visual environments offer something different: room to think, room to read, room to make a decision without feeling rushed.

That means generous white space. Clear hierarchy. Layouts that feel structured and purposeful. Every section should breathe. Every element should have a reason to be there.

Imagery should suggest intelligence, care, process, and refinement. Photography that shows hands, documents, conversation, and craft — the physical evidence of real work — is preferred over abstract lifestyle imagery. For social posts with text overlays, flat-color or lightly blurred backgrounds are strongly preferred. Legibility is never compromised for aesthetics.

ReadTomato should not look like generic SaaS. It should not look like agency theater. It should not look like empty minimalism pretending to be premium. It should look like a company that helps clients clarify what matters, clean up what is weak, and turn expertise into stronger market visibility and commercial value.

*Form should feel deliberate because the client needs to feel they are in expert hands.
Space should feel calm because our customers are already overwhelmed by clutter.*

Structure should feel clear because our job is to make their message easier to understand, trust, and act on.

0 7 - T H E W H O L E P I C T U R E

How Story, Products, and Brand Work as One

A brand is not a logo. It is not a color palette. It is the sum of every impression a company makes — through its content, its visuals, its voice, its work, and the experience of being a client.

ReadTomato's brand works when all of those things point in the same direction. When the story we tell about our company sounds like the work we actually deliver. When the visual identity conveys the same precision and craft as the content we produce. When a prospect who finds us through a blog post, a LinkedIn post, a referral, or a search result all arrive at the same place and feel the same thing: this is a company that takes their clients' businesses seriously.

The Thread That Connects Everything

The story that runs through every ReadTomato touchpoint is this: most businesses have more valuable expertise than the world currently recognizes. The gap between what they know and what their market understands is a missed commercial opportunity. ReadTomato closes that gap — through Hot Take Engine for ongoing expert content, through WebReno for the foundational digital presence, through SEO packages for the technical infrastructure that connects both to the way people search and discover.

These are not separate products aimed at separate problems. They are a coordinated system — a beginning, a middle, and a compounding ongoing — for any professional services business that wants to own their market position rather than rent it from paid advertising.

What Every Touchpoint Should Feel Like

Whether it is a cold email, a sales proposal, a social post, the website, or the work itself — every ReadTomato touchpoint should make a prospect feel the same three things:

- This company understands my market and my pressures.
- This work was made for me, not assembled from a template.
- I can trust these people with something that matters to my business.

That is the standard. Everything in this guide — the story, the products, the voice, the visual identity — exists to support it. Not to look impressive. To be useful. To serve the client. To earn the trust that makes a business relationship worth having.

"Its work should always feel meticulously crafted, commercially intelligent, and executed at a master level — so clients can see the difference and refer us because of it."

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